

Talk 5: Keeping the Door Open

Ages 6–8

Introduction

Hi, and welcome to Bright Talks.

As parents, many of us want our children to grow up feeling confident, safe, and comfortable coming to us with their questions.

Throughout this course, we've talked about growing bodies, growing curiosity, things children may hear from friends, questions about reproduction, and how to strengthen boundaries and body safety.

But underneath every one of those conversations has been something even more important:

Trust.

Because the goal isn't simply for your child to know the right information.

It's for them to know where they can always go when they need help making sense of it.

Today, we're going to talk about how to keep that door open as your child grows.

Trust Is Built in Small Moments

Trust usually isn't built during one big conversation.

It's built in ordinary moments.

When your child tells you something surprising.

When they admit they made a mistake.

When they ask an awkward question.

When they tell you something a friend said.

How we respond in those small moments teaches children what they can bring to us in the future.

Sometimes the most powerful response is simply:

"I'm really glad you told me."

That doesn't mean you agree with everything they say or that there won't sometimes be consequences.

It simply tells your child:

"You can tell me the truth, and we'll figure it out together."

Listen Before You React

As children grow, eventually they're going to tell us something we weren't expecting.

And sometimes our faces react before our words do.

Before correcting, questioning, or jumping immediately into advice, try to pause and listen.

You might say:

"Tell me more."

"How did that make you feel?"

or,

"What do you think about what happened?"

Remember one of the ideas we've practiced throughout this course:

Respond to curiosity with curiosity.

When we stay curious, we're not only gathering information.

We're showing our children that their thoughts matter to us.

Keep Creating Opportunities to Talk

Not every meaningful conversation needs to begin with:

"We need to talk."

In fact, some of the best conversations happen when we're doing something else.

Driving in the car.

Making dinner.

Walking the dog.

Getting ready for bed.

Those everyday moments can make bigger conversations feel much less intimidating.

You can also create simple check-ins:

"What's something that made you happy today?"

"Did anything happen that confused you?"

"Did you hear anything today that you have questions about?"

Your child may not always have something to say.

That's okay.

You're showing them that the door is open.

When They Tell You Something Hard

There may come a day when your child tells you something that worries you.

Maybe they broke a family rule.

Maybe they saw something inappropriate.

Maybe a friend said something confusing.

Or maybe something happened that made them uncomfortable or afraid.

In those moments, your child will be watching your response.

Take a breath.

Listen.

And remind them:

"Thank you for telling me. We'll figure out what to do together."

You can address the behavior or situation after you've made sure your child knows they are safe, heard, and loved.

Grace doesn't mean ignoring difficult things.

It means making sure difficult things don't have to be faced alone.

Preparing for the Next Stage

Six, seven, and eight can feel like such a special window.

Your child is becoming more independent, but they still need your guidance in so many ways.

Over the next several years, that independence will continue to grow.

Their bodies will change.

Friendships may become more complicated.

Technology will play a larger role.

Their questions about relationships, sexuality, and growing up will become deeper.

You don't have to prepare for all of that today.

You're preparing the relationship that will carry you through it.

Every conversation you're having now is laying a foundation for the conversations you'll have later.

A Christian Perspective

As Christian parents, we want our children to know God's truth but we also want them to understand the grace and love that surround it.

Throughout Scripture, we see a God who invites us to come to Him honestly. We don't have to hide our questions, our struggles, or even our mistakes from Him.

That's something we can model in our homes too.

You might tell your child:

"God loves you, and there is nothing you could ever ask me that would make me stop loving you. Even if you make a mistake or something happens that you're afraid to tell me about, I want you to come to me. We can talk about it, pray about it, and figure out what to do together."

That doesn't mean every choice is the right choice or that boundaries and consequences disappear.

It means love comes before the lecture.

As your child grows, you can also begin helping them understand *why* your family believes what it believes.

Instead of only saying:

"Because that's our rule,"

you might say:

"Our family believes God created us with purpose, and we want the choices we make to reflect the way He asks us to love and respect ourselves and other people."

And when your child has a question you aren't sure how to answer, you can model something else:

"That's a really good question. Let's think about what we know, what the Bible teaches us, and what we can learn together."

You don't have to be afraid of your child's questions.

Questions can become opportunities to help faith grow from something your child has simply been told into something they're beginning to understand.

Our goal isn't simply to raise children who can repeat what their parents believe.

We want to raise children who know they can seek truth, ask hard questions, receive grace when they stumble, and grow in wisdom as their faith becomes increasingly their own.

Truth gives them direction. Grace gives them somewhere to return. And love keeps the door open.

Key Takeaway

If there's one thing we hope you remember from this course, let it be this:

You don't need to have every answer. You need to keep the door open.

Keep listening.

Keep asking questions.

Keep telling the truth.

Keep showing up.

Because every time your child comes to you and is met with love, honesty, and calm guidance, you're reinforcing something they'll carry with them:

"I can bring the hard things here."

Wrapping Up

As we close this course, remember that these five talks were never meant to prepare you for one perfect conversation.

They were meant to help you begin hundreds of small ones.

Your child's questions will change.

Their body will change.

Their friendships will change.

And the world around them will continue to change too.

But through all of it, you can remain something steady:

A parent who listens.

A parent who tells the truth.

A parent who leads with both wisdom and grace.

And a parent whose door remains open.

You don't have to know exactly what every stage will bring.

The truth stays consistent. The depth grows with your child.

And when the next question comes, you'll be ready to meet them there.

Thank you for allowing Bright Talks to walk alongside your family during this stage.

Keep talking.

Keep listening.

And most importantly keep the door open.

We'll see you in the next stage of Bright Talks.